



The Normative Value of Democracy

Bangladesh vs. Pakistan

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What did I study?

- Democracy = key global issue
- Focus on developing countries
- Compare Bangladesh & Pakistan
 - Look at income + gender

How important is democracy?

Does income affect views?

Does gender matter?

Differences between countries?





Data Source

World Values Survey (2018)

Bangladesh: N = 1200

Pakistan: N = 1855

I used Wave 7 of the World Values Survey from 2018. This is a large, cross-national dataset that measures people's beliefs and values. My sample includes about 1,200 people from Bangladesh and 1,855 from Pakistan."





Variables

Dependent:

- Democracy importance (1–10)

Independent:

- Income (low/mid/high)
- Gender (male/female)

Looking for how important democracy is to each respondent, measured on a scale from 1 to 10. Then I look at two key independent variables: income, which is grouped into low, middle, and high categories, and gender, coded as male or female





Summary Statistics

Bangladesh mean: 8.11

Pakistan mean: 8.37

Both countries show very high average support for democracy. Bangladesh has a mean of about 8.11, and Pakistan is slightly higher at 8.37. So overall, people in both countries strongly value democracy.

Shared history (British India, 1947 partition)

Bangladesh was part of Pakistan until 1971

Both majority Muslim countries

Different political trajectories

Useful comparison: similar roots, different outcomes

Bangladesh:

- More stable electoral democracy (recent decades)
- Strong party competition

Pakistan:

- History of military influence
- Less consistent democratic rule

Public trust shaped by these experiences

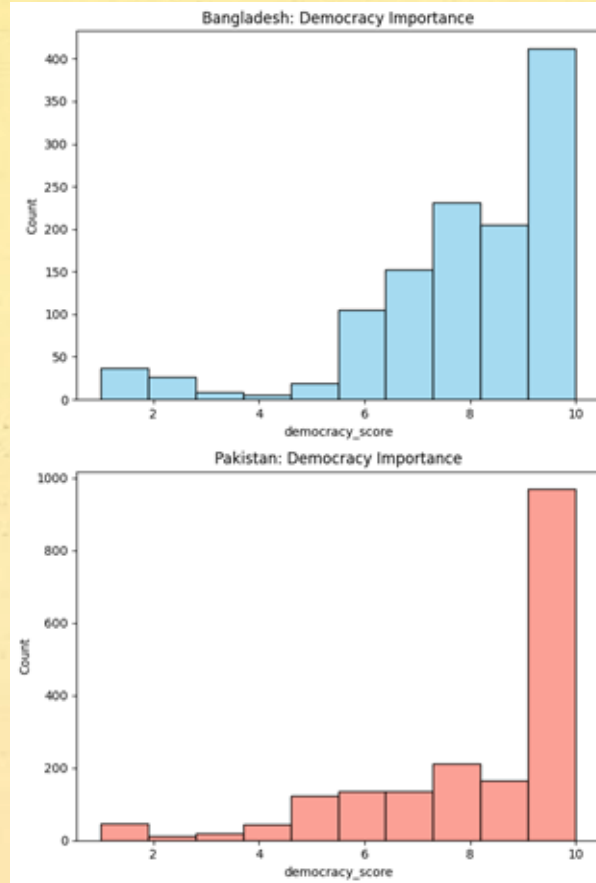




Visual Findings

Most responses near 10
Left-skewed distribution
“Ceiling effect”
Income:

- Bangladesh → middle
- Pakistan → lower



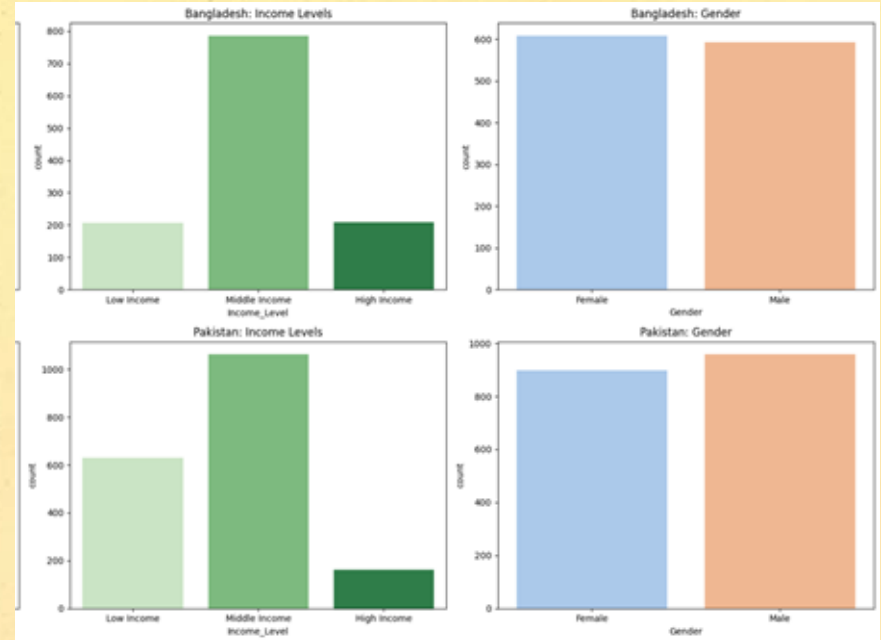


Methodology

OLS regression
Predict democracy importance
Variables:

- Income
- Gender

This allows me to estimate how income and gender predict the importance of democracy, while holding other factors constant.”





Results for Bangladesh

Income: +0.27

Female: -0.41

Both significant

In Bangladesh, income has a positive and statistically significant effect. This means that as income increases, support for democracy also increases. On the other hand, being female is associated with slightly lower support for democracy compared to males, and this result is also statistically significant.”

Results for Pakistan

Income: -0.27

Gender: not significant

In Pakistan, the results are actually very different. Income has a negative relationship with support for democracy, meaning higher-income individuals are less supportive. Gender, however, is not statistically significant, so it doesn't really affect attitudes toward democracy in Pakistan





Comparison

Bangladesh:

- Income $\uparrow \rightarrow$ support $\uparrow$
- Gender matters

Pakistan:

- Income $\uparrow \rightarrow$ support $\downarrow$
- Gender doesn't matter

When we compare the two countries, we see very different patterns. In Bangladesh, higher income increases support for democracy and gender plays a role. But in Pakistan, higher income actually decreases support, and gender has no meaningful effect.





Conclusion

- Democracy valued in both
- Drivers differ
- Context matters

To conclude, both countries strongly value democracy overall. However, the reasons behind that support differ. In Bangladesh, income and gender are important factors, while in Pakistan, income works in the opposite direction and gender is not important. This suggests that political attitudes are shaped by each country's unique social and economic context.

- Same outcome, different causes
- Income effects vary
- Culture matters

The key takeaway is that even though both countries show high support for democracy, the underlying causes are different. Income doesn't work the same way everywhere, and cultural context plays a major role in shaping political beliefs.

